

Complex Sentences with Time Clauses

In this section, you will look at complex sentences that contain an independent clause and a special kind of dependent clause known as a **time clause**. A time clause is a dependent clause that has a subject and verb and begins with an introductory word known as a **time subordinator**. Time clauses are easy to identify because they answer the question *When?*



Here are examples of common time subordinators and how you can use them in complex sentences:

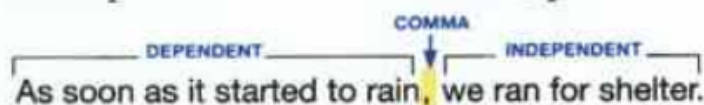
	TIME SUBORDINATORS
<u>after</u>	I will go straight to bed after I finish writing this paragraph.
<u>as soon as</u> / Once	She felt better as soon as she took the medicine.
<u>before</u>	Wait for a green light before you cross a street.
<u>since</u>	It has been a year since I left home.
<u>until</u>	We can't leave the room until everyone finishes the test.
<u>when</u>	Where were you when I called?
<u>whenever</u>	Whenever I don't sleep well, I feel sick the next day.
<u>while</u>	My neighbors were having a party while I was trying to sleep.

Note that in complex sentences with time clauses, the independent and dependent clauses can be in any order.

- If the independent clause comes first, don't use a comma.



- If the dependent clause comes first, put a comma after it.



Underline each independent clause once and each dependent clause twice. Circle each time subordinator and add a comma as needed.

1. After we won the lottery last year, my wife and I immediately decided to take a trip.
2. We were very excited when we won.
3. After we got our first payment, we started planning a trip to Italy.
4. Before we left on our trip, we wrote to our cousins in Rome and told them our plans.
5. As soon as they received our letter, they called and invited us to stay with them.
6. They were waiting at the airport when we arrived.
7. They waited outside while the Italian officials carefully checked our passports and luggage.
8. Finally, after we got our suitcases, they drove us to their home.
9. As soon as we arrived at their apartment, they wanted to feed us.
10. We ate one delicious home-cooked dish after another until we were very full.
11. We fell asleep as soon as our heads hit the pillows.
12. Almost 24 hours had passed since we left home.

Combine each pair of sentences by using an adverb time clause. Add a comma if necessary. Write your sentences in paragraph form on a separate sheet of paper. Circle the subordinators.

1. Everyone should know what to do. An earthquake strikes.

Everyone should know what to do when an earthquake strikes.

2. If you are inside, move away from windows, and get under a desk or table, or stand in a doorway. You feel the floor begin to shake.

as soon as/once

3. Try to stay calm. The earthquake is happening.

while

4. Do not move. The floor stops shaking.

until

5. You are sure the earthquake is over. You may begin to move around.

After/When

6. You have checked carefully for fallen power lines. You may go outside.

After/ Until /When/Once

- B** Read each clause in column A. Find the clause in column B that completes it, and write the letter of the clause on the line. (HINT: When completed, the sentences tell a continuous story.)

A

1. The trip began badly b
2. It was almost noon g
3. As soon as I threw out my fishing line, f
4. I spent most of the afternoon untangling¹ my line e
5. After we had been fishing for a couple of hours, h
6. We were totally wet a
7. When we got back home, d
8. It will be a long, long time c

B

- a. before we could put on our rain jackets.
- ~~b.~~ when we had a flat tire on the way to the lake.
- c. until I go fishing with my brothers again.
- d. I immediately took a hot shower.
- e. while my brothers were catching fish after fish.
- f. it got caught in some underwater weeds.
- g. before we started fishing.
- h. it started to rain.

CONNECTING SENTENCES WITH CONJUNCTIVE ADVERBS

A conjunctive adverb is often at the beginning of a sentence, followed by **a comma**. It functions as an adverb which indicates the cohesive relation between a sentence and the one preceding that sentence.

CONJUNCTIVE ADVERBS		
Conjunctive Adverb	Meaning / Use	Examples
also besides furthermore in addition moreover	To add a similar, equal idea	Community colleges offer preparation for many jobs. Moreover, they prepare students to transfer to a four-year college or university.
however nevertheless nonetheless still	To add an unexpected or surprising continuation	The cost of attending a community college is low. Still, many students need financial aid.
on the other hand in contrast	To add a complete contrast	Tuition at a community college is low. On the other hand, tuition at private schools is high.
otherwise	To give an alternative possibility, often negative	Students must take final exams. Otherwise, they will receive a grade of Incomplete.
accordingly as a result consequently hence therefore thus	To add an expected result	Native and nonnative English speakers have different needs. Thus, most schools provide separate English classes for each group.

(2 different things that co-exist)

in fact indeed	To introduce a restatement or explanation	One of the first things you notice is that for Americans, time seems as valuable as money. In fact, they even have a saying, "Time is money."
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Read the paragraphs and circle the transition signals. Punctuate them as needed.

Genetic¹ Engineering

Genetic research has produced both exciting and frightening possibilities. Scientists are now able to create new forms of life in the laboratory because of the development of gene splicing². On the one hand, the ability to create life in the laboratory could greatly benefit humankind. Indeed, agriculture has already benefited from applications of gene splicing. For example, researchers have engineered a more nutritious type of rice that could help alleviate the serious problem of vitamin A deficiency. It is estimated that more than 124 million children worldwide lack vitamin A, which puts them at risk for permanent blindness and other health issues. In addition, genetic engineers have created larger fish, frost-resistant strawberries, and cows that produce more milk.

On the other hand, some people feel that gene-splicing technology could have terrible consequences. In fact, a type of corn engineered to kill a certain insect pest also threatened to annihilate³ desirable monarch butterflies. In another accident, a genetically engineered type of corn that was approved only for animal consumption because it was toxic to humans accidentally cross-pollinated with corn grown for humans. As a result, many countries banned imports of genetically modified corn for several years. Furthermore, the ability to clone human beings is a possibility that frightens many people. In 2004, two South Korean scientists reported that they had successfully cloned a human embryo (Dreifus). The embryo did not develop into a baby. However, it is possible that one could do so in the future, a possibility that not everyone is comfortable with.

Practice 9: Add conjunctive adverbs

Complete the sentences below with appropriate conjunctive adverbs.

1. The city administration introduced a ban on free plastic bags. As a consequence, plastic pollution in the city's streets and rivers has fallen dramatically.
2. The city administration introduced a ban on free plastic bags. On the other hand, many supermarkets are still giving away free bags with shopping.
3. The city administration introduced a ban on free plastic bags. Furthermore, it is selling discounted reusable bags to local people.
4. The world's oceans are becoming increasingly polluted with plastics. Nevertheless, scientists are having problems providing evidence of the toxic effects on some species due to the difficulty of collecting data under hazardous conditions in open water.
5. The world's oceans are becoming increasingly polluted with plastics. Moreover, it is time for consumers to take more care in their weekly shopping.
6. The world's oceans are becoming increasingly polluted with plastics. Furthermore, plastic pollution is becoming a serious problem in freshwater lakes and rivers.

(truths, events, number, names.....T/F)

FACTS AND OPINIONS

(thoughts, ideas, beliefs, attitudes....)

An **opinion** is what someone believes. People can disagree with opinions. A **fact**, however, is a true statement that no one can disagree with.

Read these sentence pairs. Which ones are facts, and which ones are opinions?

The sun rises in the east. **F**

The sunrise was beautiful this morning. **O**

The temperature of the lake is 55 degrees Fahrenheit.

The lake is too cold for swimming. **O**

According to highway accident reports, using a cell phone while driving is dangerous.

Using a cell phone while driving is dangerous. **O**

Women could not vote in the United States until 1920.

Everyone should vote. **O**

Mrs. King said, "I am a good mother." **F**

Mrs. King is a good mother. **O**

The sentences in the left column are facts. They are true. Even the last sentence, "Mrs. King said, 'I am a good mother,'" is a fact. It is true that she said that. What she said—"I am a good mother"—is an opinion. However, a statement that reports what she said is a fact because no one can disagree that she said it.

The sentences in the right column are opinions. They may or may not be true.

A opinion will be more convincing if it is supported by facts.

TASK 2: Identify Statements as Facts or Opinions

Indicate whether each of the following statements is a fact or an opinion.

		Fact	Opinion
1	Tuition fees <u>should be</u> abolished.		✓
2	Colleges and universities rely on tuition fees to fund teaching and research.	✓	
3	International students <u>should not</u> pay higher tuition fees than domestic students.		✓
4	International students often pay higher tuition fees than domestic students.	✓	
5	Many countries charge tuition fees for higher education.	✓	

OPINION PARAGRAPHS

An **opinion** is a statement of someone's belief. When you say, "I believe . . ." or "I think that . . .," you are expressing an opinion. In everyday life, people talk and write about their opinion or point of view on a wide variety of issues. Examples include: Should smoking be allowed everywhere? Do you agree with restrictions on teenagers during their first year of driving? Should the government ban the sale of handguns?

If you look at the "Letters to the Editor" section of any newspaper, you will find letters from people discussing their points of view. People post their opinions on online news sites and in blogs. In college classes, you often have to express and support your opinions.

Here are four keys to writing a successful opinion paragraph:

- State your opinion clearly in the topic sentence. (Disagree/Agree)
- Present the reasons for your opinion in logical order. (Least -> Most important)
- Use facts to support each reason. (Main points) (Mostly obvious -> less obvious)
- End with a powerful concluding sentence that your reader will remember. (supporting details: research, statistics, news story, opinion of an expert, cause/effect.....) (Restating your opinion in the topic sentence + adding a recommendation)

LOOKING AT THE MODEL

The writing model contains one writer's opinion about video games.

Work with a partner or in a small group. Read the model. Then answer the questions.



Writing Model

Video Games and Violence

In my opinion, violent video games are harmful to young people. First of all, studies show that playing these games can cause changes in the behavior of young people. According to researchers, immediately after playing these games, young people have more aggressive thoughts and angry feelings. In addition, frequent players get into more fights at school and have more arguments with their teachers. A second reason that violent video games are harmful to young people is that, in my opinion, they make young people less sensitive to violence in the real world. I believe that these games make it entertaining to shoot and kill, and the line between imaginary violence and real violence

becomes very thin or disappears entirely for children. Thirteen-year-old Noah Wilson, for example, was stabbed to death by a friend who often played the violent game *Mortal Kombat*. On a talk show that I watched recently, Noah's mother claimed that the boy who stabbed her son was acting out the part of Cyrex, a character in the game. A third reason is that in my opinion, children who do not have good home situations or who have emotional problems may not understand that violence is not a good solution. An extreme example of this kind of thinking resulted in the Columbine High School massacre¹ in 1999. Two students shot and killed 12 classmates, a teacher, and themselves at the Colorado high school. The two young killers were fans of the video games *Doom* and *Wolfenstein 3D*. For these three reasons, I feel that violent video games are harmful to young people and should be controlled—or, even better, banned².

restating the topic sentence
recommndation

Sources:

1. Jill U. Adams, "Effects of violent video games," the *Los Angeles Times*, May 3, 2010, articles.latimes.com/2010/may/03/health/la-he-closer-20100503 (accessed July 1, 2012).
2. Paraphrase from a transcript of the television program *Donahue*, July 22, 2002, lionlamb.org/news_articles/donahue_july_22.htm (accessed November 3, 2006).

¹ **massacre:** murder of many people

² **banned:** prohibited, not allowed

Questions about the Model

1. What is the writer's opinion about violent video games? What phrase does he use to introduce his opinion?
2. How many reasons does the writer give for his opinion?
3. What transition signals does the writer use to introduce his reasons?
4. In your opinion, which reason is stronger: the first one or the last one? Why?

Looking at Vocabulary: Word Forms

Learning word forms is a good way to expand your vocabulary and add more variety to your writing. For example, if you know both the noun and adjective forms of a word, you can avoid repeating the same words over and over.

A second reason that **violent** video games are harmful to young people is that, in my opinion, they make young people less sensitive to **violence** in the real world.

PRACTICE 2 Looking at Word Forms

- A** Look at the writing model. Find and underline the adjective forms of the nouns in the first column. Then write the adjectives you found in the second column.

NOUNS	ADJECTIVES
1. violence	<u>violent</u>
2. harm	<u>harmful</u> <harmless
3. aggression	<u>aggressive</u>
4. anger	<u>angry</u>
5. sensitivity	<u>sensitive</u>
6. entertainment	<u>entertaining</u>
7. imagination	<u>imaginative</u> imaginable imaginary
8. emotion	<u>emotional</u>

- B** Circle the correct word form that completes each sentence.

- Some parents disapprove of video games that promote (violence / violent).
- They are afraid that such games do more (harm / harmful) than good.
- Video games are a popular form of (entertainment / entertaining) for many people.
- Some people believe that children show more (aggression / aggressive) after playing violent video games.
- During the last part of the movie, my friend became very (emotion / emotional) and began to cry.
- Since he was a child, the artist has always had a wild (imagination / imaginative).
- I didn't think that the TV show was very (entertainment / entertaining).
- Clara has a great (sensitivity / sensitive) for animals. She seems to understand them very well.

PRACTICE 3

Identifying Facts and Opinions

Complete the outline for the writing model on pages 168–169. Use full sentences, but do not include transition signals. Then analyze each sentence in the column on the right. Write *F* for fact and *O* for opinion.

	Video Games and Violence	
TOPIC SENTENCE	In my opinion, violent video games are harmful to young people.	<u>O</u>
1ST REASON	A. Studies show that playing these games can <u>cause changes in</u> the behavior of young people.	<u>F</u>
SUPPORTING DETAILS	1. According to researchers, immediately after playing these games, players have more aggressive thoughts and angry feelings.	<u>F</u>
	2. Frequent players get into more fights at school and have more arguments with their teachers.	<u>F</u>
2ND REASON	B. In my opinion, they make young people less sensitive to violence.	<u>O</u>
SUPPORTING DETAILS	1. <u>I believe that these games make it.....</u>	<u>O</u>
	2. <u>Noah Wilson (13) was stabbed to death by a friend who often played the violent game <u>Mortal Kombat</u>.</u> relevant	<u>F</u>
	3. On a talk show I watched recently, <u>Noah's mother claimed</u> that the boy who stabbed her son was acting out the part of Cyrex, a character in <u>Mortal Kombat</u> . sufficient	<u>F</u>
3RD REASON	C. <u>In my opinion, children who do not.....not a good solutions</u>	<u>O</u>
SUPPORTING DETAILS	1. An extreme example of this thinking resulted in the Columbine High School massacre in 1999.	<u>F</u>
	2. <u>Two students.....high school</u> relevant	<u>F</u>
	3. The two young killers were fans of the video games <u>Doom and Wolfenstein 3D</u> . sufficient	<u>F</u>
CONCLUDING SENTENCE	For these 3 reasons, I feel that...banned	<u>O</u>

Of course, you can use opinions as reasons, but your paragraph will be stronger and more convincing if you support your opinion with facts.

The main reasons can be stated as opinions, but supporting details should be purely facts. Facts should be both relevant and sufficient.